Gaming

Ultimate Fire Slot Preview

In this note, we provide a preview of the upcoming result for Light & Wonder (LNW). We as also provide an update on various datasets & changes to the industry landscape.

Aristocrat (Positive, $65.82/sh valuation)

Reporting in May

The slots industry can be rather cyclical around replacement cycles, market expansions and the timing of new hit games. For Aristocrat, it appears that their 1H26 result in May will be catalyst-lite. Instead, the focus will be on whether they can continue their momentum as the premium supplier of content. Our industry feedback suggests that Aristocrat continues to expand existing franchises well and the Baron cabinet has plenty more runway.

By contrast, 2H26 looks like it will feature multiple growth catalysts. These include: (i) the launch of key new premium lease games led by Monopoly, (ii) the launch of Lightning Link in iGaming, and (iii) new iLottery contracts in Massachusetts and Michigan (transition from JV to solo licence).

Unfortunately for Aristocrat, recent FX movements are a negative drag on earnings. We believe this has been a key factor for the recent share price weakness and is the primary driver of our -5.9% price target reduction.

Light & Wonder (Positive, $246/sh valuation)

Wednesday 25th February

We are marginally ahead of consensus expectations for LNW's 4Q25 result (+1.1% AEBITDA). The primary driver of this is a robust North American market and LNW's consistent improvement in the Eilers game performance surveys. In particular, we believe Ultimate Fire Link will have driven material net adds to their premium lease footprint and the Piggy Bankin' franchise will have improved outright sales volumes.

Following the settlement of the Dragon Train lawsuit (see here) and their move from the Nasdaq, 2026 feels like a clean slate for LNW. Interestingly, their 2026 catalysts are front-half weighted, i.e. the opposite of Aristocrat. The first half of 2026 will see the benefits of e-pull tabs in Indiana, for which LNW has already started placing units. However, the second half will see headwinds for LNW's premium lease footprint. These include the churn of Monopoly units as their licence concludes and the conversion of leased VLT units to outright sales at Genting's Resorts World NYC casino.

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Top New Games

Most Anticipated Games at G2E

In our last quarterly preview (see here), we discussed the G2E feedback we had from casino operators about the best new content displayed. For Aristocrat, these titles have yet to hit casino floors. This includes Monopoly, which was comfortably the most hyped game. For LNW, the content to look out for was the Lightwave Cabinet, which was launching with the game Frankenstein Returns, and the Piggy Bankin' franchise. Both of these have hit casinos and feature on the Eilers game performance reports.

Thus far, Frankenstein Returns (Lightwave) has unfortunately been below expectations.

- The latest game performance report shows a theoretical win vs. zone of 1.95x. This is respectable, but we have typically observed that a game's best performance is in its initial 1–2 months before declining.
  - In particular, games that start off below 2.0x in the premium lease category are highly unlikely to sustain material floor share.
- Furthermore, the Lightwave cabinet is an expensive, feature-rich cabinet.
  - Casinos are increasingly steering away from variable fee per day WAP games in favour of fixed fee per day games.
- Although we don't expect the game to be a long-term contributor, we suspect the game has still driven some net installs for LNW.
  - Most casinos will give the supplier of an underperforming game the opportunity to substitute it with another game if an appropriate replacement exists.

By contrast, the Piggy Bankin' franchise has been performing well.

- Piggy Bankin - Break In has been a very strong core game.
  - The game is currently performing at 2.11x. This is the second-best in the category behind Spooky Link.

Exhibit 1 - Frankenstein Returns on the Lightwave Cabinet



Source: Light & Wonder

Exhibit 2 - Piggy Bankin - Break In



Source: Light & Wonder

Ultimate Fire Link

Since covid, Ultimate Fire Link (UFL) has been LNW's top franchise. UFL has been a staple in the Top-5 premium lease franchises, but stagnated a little in 2024.

In our last preview (see here), we observed how the release of UFL Triple Nova has reinvigorated the franchise into growth mode. Eilers now tracks 653 sampled units (probably closer to 2,000 in true population) and we believe the franchise has had the greatest market share gains over the last six months.

Exhibit 3 - Ultimate Fire Link Triple Nova



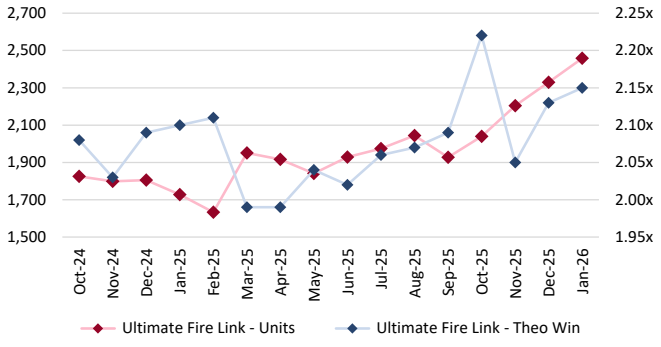
Source: Light & Wonder

Exhibit 4 - Top Performing Ultimate Fire Link Slot Games

Game Ranking	Game Name	Days on Floor	Slots in Survey	Theo Win vs. Zone
40	UFL Triple Nova - Big Money Edition - Desert Nights	17	15	2.11x
10	UFL Triple Nova - Paradise Lights	99	299	2.55x
8	UFL Triple Nova - Desert Nights	106	354	2.70x
543	UFL Cash Falls - By The Bay	148	11	1.02x
465	UFL Power 4 Wheel	169	31	1.08x
234	UFL Cash Falls - Olvera Street	280	83	1.40x
294	UFL Double Explosion	301	26	1.27x
161	UFL Explosion	332	43	1.58x
66	UFL - By The Bay	503	365	1.95x
83	UFL - Rue Royale	507	116	1.84x
95	UFL - Country Lights	525	33	1.78x
202	UFL Cash Falls - China Street	536	90	1.48x
32	UFL - Glacier Gold	544	342	2.16x
103	UFL - Forest Wild	549	36	1.74x
86	UFL - Route 66	566	129	1.82x
39	UFL - China Street	619	614	2.11x
160	UFL Power 4	658	41	1.58x
46	UFL - Olvera Street	674	435	2.07x
128	UFL - North Shore	862	62	1.67x
77	UFL - River Walk	918	31	1.87x

Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Exhibit 5 - Ultimate Fire Link Franchise - Units (LHS) & Theo Win (RHS)



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Spooky Link

Aristocrat's Spooky Link was the franchise we believed was going under the radar and had Top-5 potential in our August preview last year (see here).

- In the latest game performance report, Spooky Link was the third best performing franchise at 2.33x theo win vs. zone.
- Spooky Link is clearly the top performing core franchise. The next highest is doing 1.60x theo win vs. zone.
- The franchise that Spooky Link most resembles in scale and performance remains Phoenix Link.

Exhibit 6 - Spooky Link



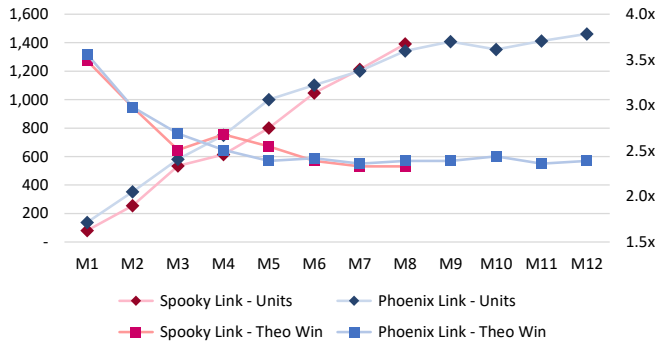
Source: Aristocrat

Exhibit 7 - Top Indexing Overall Parent Games

Rank	Game	Supplier	Slots	TvZ	Category
1	Dragon Link	Aristocrat	5,447	2.93x	Premium
2	Phoenix Link	Aristocrat	1,515	2.43x	Premium
3	Spooky Link	Aristocrat	1,391	2.33x	Core
4	House of the Dragon	Aristocrat	385	2.31x	Premium
5	Kong Skull Island	Light & Wonder	396	2.23x	Premium
6	Ultimate Fire Link	Light & Wonder	3,174	2.09x	Premium
7	Dollar Storm	Aristocrat	926	2.03x	Premium
8	Lightning Dollar Link	Aristocrat	527	1.99x	Premium
9	Monster	Light & Wonder	360	1.90x	Premium
10	Lightning Link	Aristocrat	2,445	1.87x	Premium
11	Money Gong	Igt	389	1.64x	Premium
12	Cash Express Legend	Aristocrat	331	1.63x	Premium
13	4 UP	Aristocrat	559	1.60x	Core
14	Wheel of Fortune	Igt	1,133	1.58x	Premium
15	Ultimate Fast Cash	Aristocrat	404	1.58x	Premium
16	Railroad Riches	Sega Sammy	733	1.55x	Core
17	Lion Link	Light & Wonder	1,568	1.55x	Mostly Core
18	Firecracker Fortunes	Aristocrat	271	1.55x	Core
19	Mystery of the Lamp	Igt	698	1.52x	Premium
20	Monopoly	Light & Wonder	999	1.52x	Premium

Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates. Notes: Eilers minimum is 264 slots in the survey.

Exhibit 8 - Spooky Link vs Phoenix Link - Units (LHS) & Theo Win (RHS)



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Buffalo Mega Stampede

We believe that Aristocrat's Buffalo Mega Stampede is the best-performing recent premium lease release.

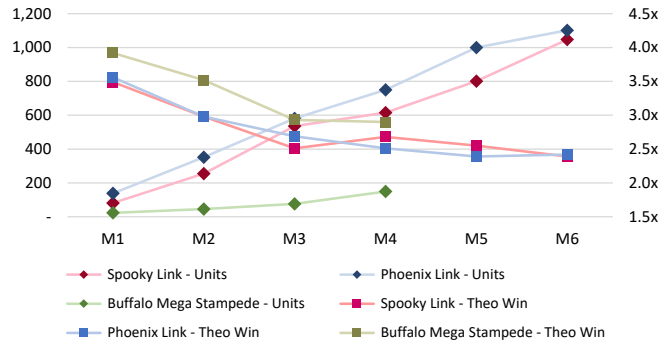
- The game is currently performing at 2.95x theo win vs. zone in its fourth on the Eilers charts.
- However, relative to Spooky Link & Phoenix Link, Buffalo Mega Stampede has been scaling much slower.

Exhibit 9 - Buffalo Mega Stampede



Source: Aristocrat

Exhibit 10 - Buffalo Mega Stampede vs Spooky Link & Phoenix Link - Units (LHS) & Theo Win (RHS)



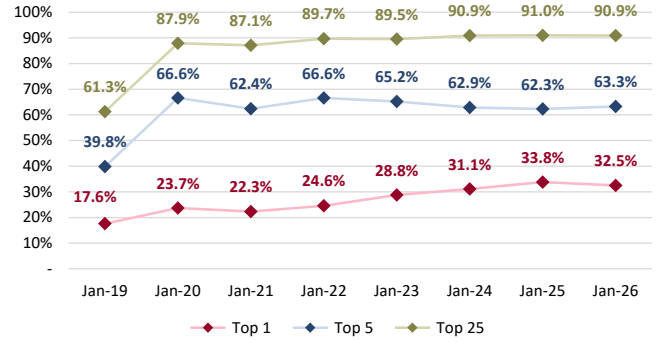
Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Top Performing Franchises

We have previously written about how the premium lease market share is becoming more concentrated among fewer franchises. This concentration means that actual or potential hit games are becoming increasingly important.

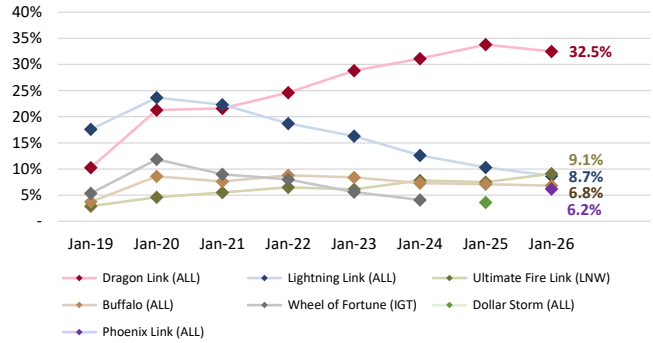
- In fact, from Jan-19 until Oct-24, the same five franchises were the top-grossing franchises.
  - The extension titles of two of these franchises were featured in the previous section (UFL & Buffalo).

Exhibit 11 - Top Premium Lease & WAP Franchises based on Net Win - Market Fragmentation



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Exhibit 12 - Top 5 Premium Lease & WAP Franchises based on Net Win

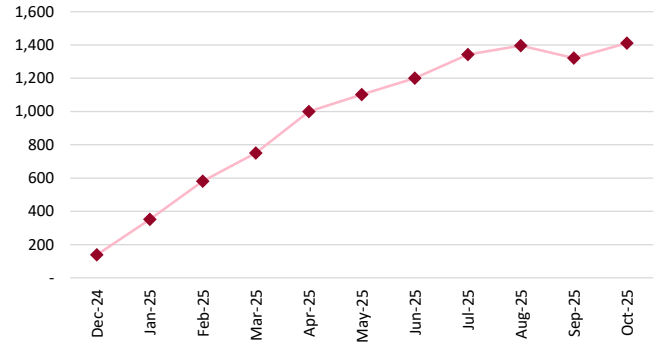


Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

The latest franchise to crack the Top-5 was Phoenix Link.

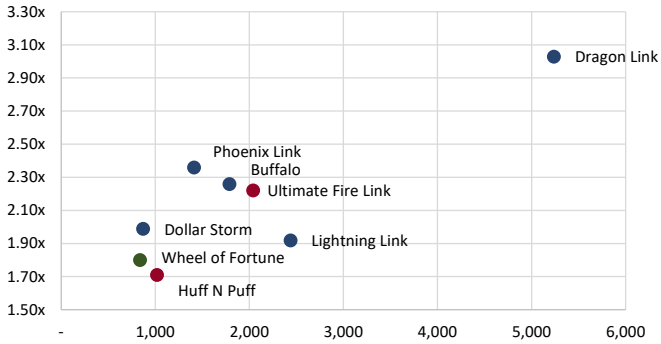
- Phoenix Link's initial performance made many people in the industry believe that Phoenix Link may have become Aristocrat's next generational game.
  - However, by its second month it became apparent that Phoenix Link was a strong game, but based on game performance, it would not take Dragon Link's crown.
- Although the growth of Phoenix Link's install base appears to have slowed, we are hesitant to jump to an early conclusion that it has reached full scale.
  - Phoenix Link's performance in the latest Eilers report was robust at 2.43x theo win vs. zone.
    - This ranks second on the Eilers top overall franchises and is an uplift vs. recent months.
- As far as we can tell, the main reason casinos wouldn't add more is if Phoenix Link is completely outclassed by Dragon Link.
  - While there are similarities, our industry feedback has been that Phoenix Link does attract new customers and drives incremental revenue.

Exhibit 13 - Phoenix Link Units on Eilers Game Performance Report



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates. Note: the figures should be used only as a guide as the survey does not represent entire population.

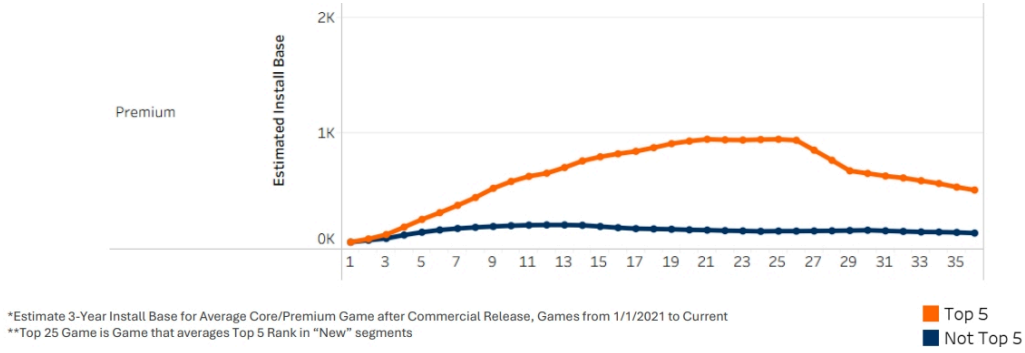
Exhibit 14 - Top Premium Lease Franchises by Unit Count (x-axis) & Theo Win vs. Zone (y-axis)



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates. Note: Unit count figures should be used only as a guide as the survey does not represent entire population.

The chart below shows that of the Top-5 Premium Lease games, peak scale is usually at around 20-months since launch. Dragon Link is the clear exception to this (and most other industry trends).

Exhibit 15 - 3-Year Install Base, Top 5 vs Non-Top 5 New Games



Source: Eilers & Krejcik

Market Share Movements

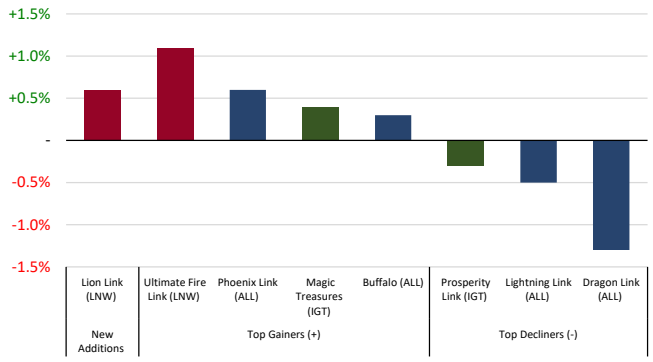
Below, we show the premium lease franchises with the largest net changes in premium lease market share.

- Ultimate Fire Link was the biggest gainer over the past three months (December quarter).
- Phoenix Link gained more in the December quarter than it did in the September quarter.
- Buffalo was ceding share in the September quarter but has bounced back in December due to Buffalo Mega Stampede.
- Lightning Link has ceded share three consecutive quarters. The new extensions displayed at G2E could help stabilise this.
- On aggregate, LNW gained the most in premium lease market share in 2025 while Aristocrat gained the most in core.

We acknowledge there may be some potential sample bias, particularly for the established franchises rather than the new additions.

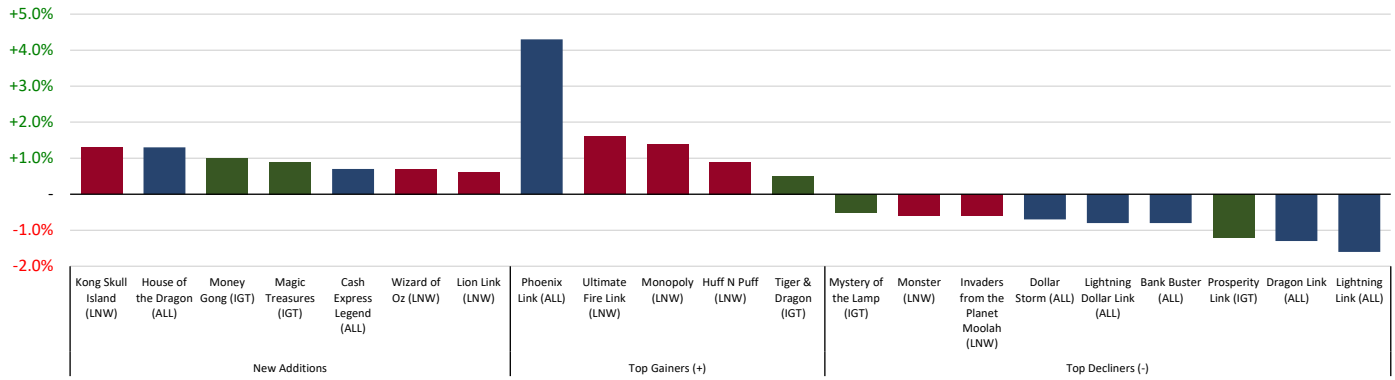
- We believe this impacted Dragon Link the most given it appears to have ceded share in the charts below but gained share in our prior report.
- We note that the sample below is relative to other premium lease franchises, not the overall market. Given the increase in the premium lease footprint over the past few years, market share declines in the below charts do not necessarily mean that the franchise saw a reduction in physical footprint.

Exhibit 16 - 3 Month Net Change in % of Theo Win - Top Grossing Premium Lease & WAP Parent Games



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Exhibit 17 - 12 Month Net Change in % of Theo Win - Top Grossing Premium Lease & WAP Parent Games

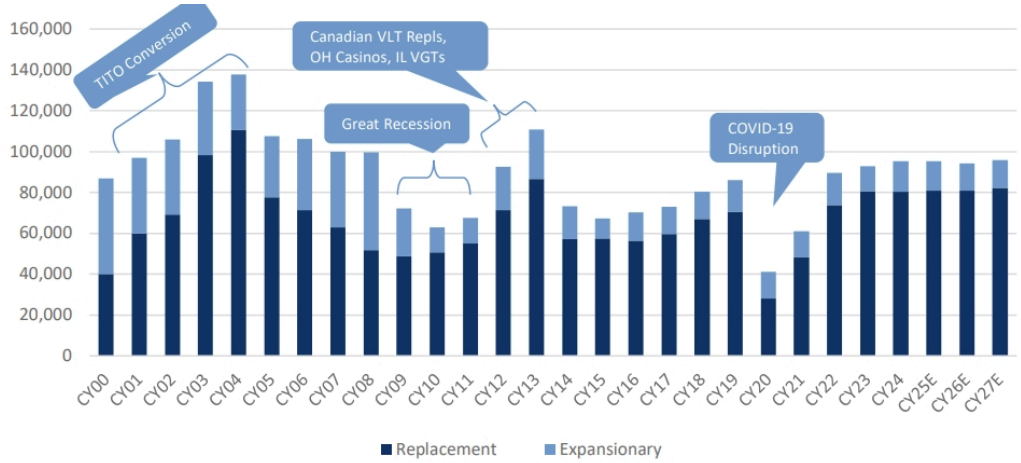


Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Casino Capex Cycle

North American outright sales have been robust since COVID. There were previously concerns about a weak CY25 due to a combination of tariff-related disruption, Canadian embargoes & stagnant macro growth. All of these have eased to varying degrees and Eilers now expects outright sales to be flat yoy.

Exhibit 18 - Total Annual North America Slot Shipments

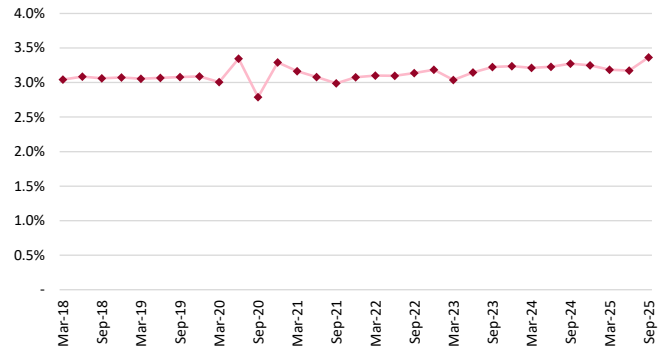


Source: Eilers & Krejcik

Below we have show the US B2B slot manufacturing revenue as a proportion of the overall slot GGR.

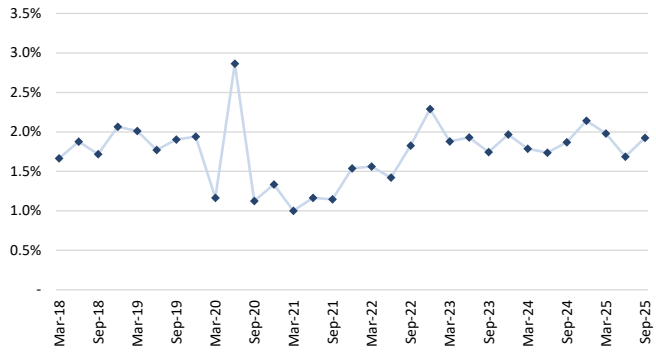
- Gaming Ops revenue has been consistent at ~3.0% of US slot GGR, although the Sep-25 qtr saw a slight uplift.
- Outright Sales revenue has been more volatile but has still generally been between 1.5% and 2.0% excluding the covid affected years.

Exhibit 19 - US B2B Gaming Ops Revenue as a % of US Slot GGR



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Exhibit 20 - US B2B Outright Sales Revenue as a % of US Slot GGR



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, E&P Estimates

Chicago VGT's

One potential new market that would result in a meaningful expansion of unit sales is if VGT's (video gaming terminals) are legalised in Chicago. VGT's were initially legalised statewide in Illinois in 2009, but the Act gave individual municipalities the right to opt out. Since then, most Illinois municipalities have allowed VGT's to increase tax revenue. As such, there are now a total of ~49.5k VGT's in Illinois.

Chicago had previously allowed casinos but opted out of VGT's. This appears likely to change following the passage of the City Council's 2026 budget in December, which included a framework for legalisation. It is not a done deal yet, as Mayor Brandon Johnson holds broad power over implementation of the policy and is currently in negotiations with other government officials. A key issue remains the tax revenue distribution as Chicago is looking to address a $1.2bn budget deficit. As it stands, Chicago would receive just 5% of the revenue from the machines, while state government would receive 30%.

Currently, it seems more likely than not that VGT's in Chicago proceed. Under citywide rollout scenario, there would be a total addressable market of ~21k units. Eilers forecasts that if legalised ~10k to 15k units would be placed. Assuming no negotiation-related delays, we expect that the bulk of these units would be placed in the second half of 2026 and early 2027.

New York Leased Unit Conversion

Another near-term licensing change that will cause some near-term volatility in the supplier revenue mix is the conversion of the facility at Genting’s Resorts World NYC casino. In December, the New York State Gaming Commission voted to license three new commercial casinos. The new licence for the Genting property in Queens is for a conversion from a gaming facility with only leased VLT units to a full Class III gaming facility with slots and table games.

The property currently has 4.6k leased VLT units. Eilers expects the biggest impact to be a ~3.9k-unit drag on this leased footprint (reduction). This would primarily impact IGT and LNW.

Land-Based GGR Trends

US Data

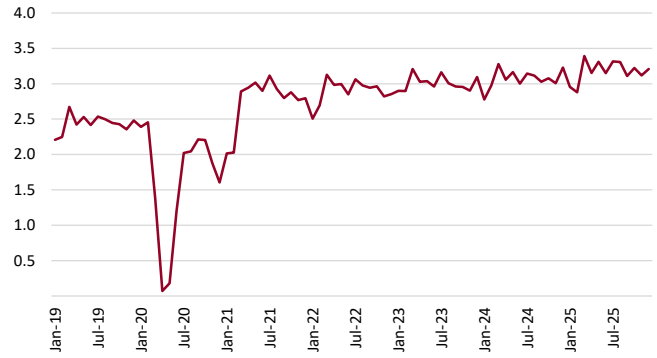
December Slot GGR fell -0.6% yoy.

- 8 out of 21 states saw positive yoy growth
- We believe that poor weather in the US Northeast had an impact.
  - Multiple storm days hit right in the post-Christmas travel window (Storm Devin). New York and New Jersey both declared a state of emergency. Officials urged people to stay off the roads and 30,000+ flights were delayed.
  - Dec-24 had some poor weather, but this was mainly in the US Southeast & West Coast, to which our sample has less exposure.

US GGR has generally been robust throughout CY25 with some exceptions.

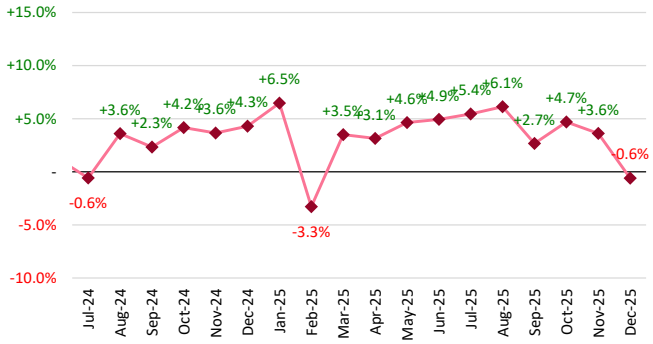
- The weakness in February (-3.3%) was driven by adverse weather and a leap-year comp.
- September was impacted by the timing of Labour Day - i.e. the benefits of the weekend aided August at the expense of September.
- Slot GGR continues to be more robust than table games.

Exhibit 21 - US Monthly Slot GGR (US$bn.)



Source: UNLV, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

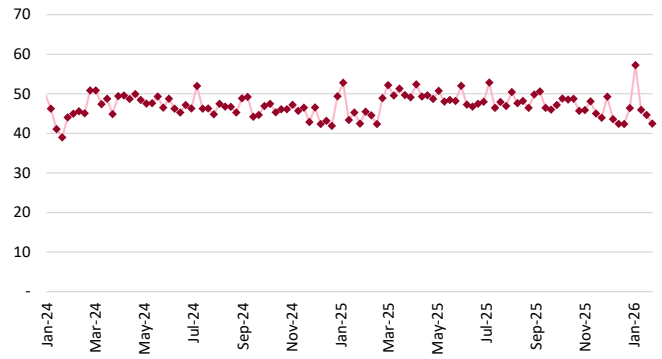
Exhibit 22 - US Slot GGR growth rate (YoY)



Source: UNLV, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

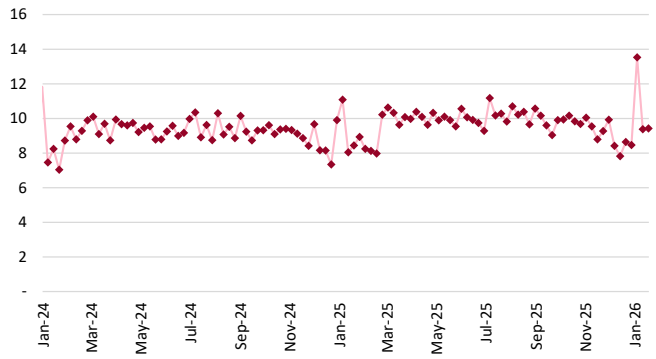
New York's weekly VLT GGR data appears to have been very soft in mid-December but delivered record GGR in the week around NYE.

Exhibit 23 - Weekly New York VLT GGR (US$m)



Source: Various state gaming bodies, E&P estimates

Exhibit 24 - Weekly New York Casino Slot GGR (US$m)

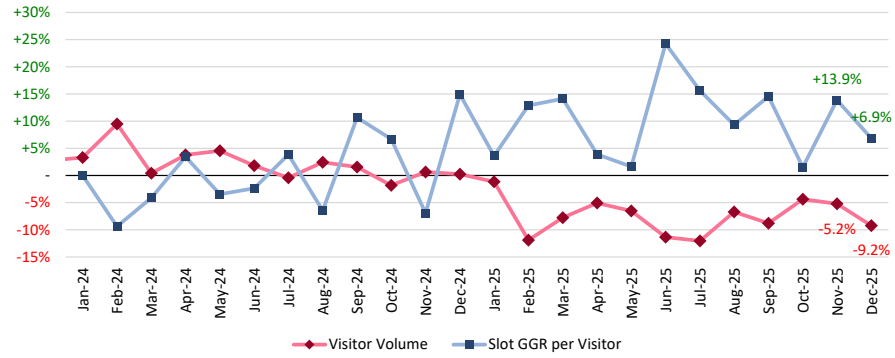


Source: Various state gaming bodies, E&P estimates

Las Vegas slot GGR continues to see soft visitor volumes offset by strong spend per visitor.

- In December, visitation was down -9.2% while spend per visitor was up +6.9%.

Exhibit 25 - Las Vegas Visitation and Slot GGR per Visitor (YoY)

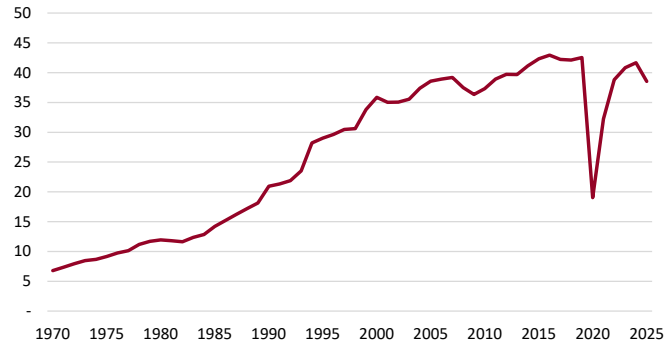


Source: UNLV, various state gaming bodies,LVCVA, E&P Estimates. Note: figures are for Clark County only.

If we look at the dynamics of Las Vegas over the long-term, we can observe that visitation has not recovered to pre-covid levels. We believe this is for the following reasons:

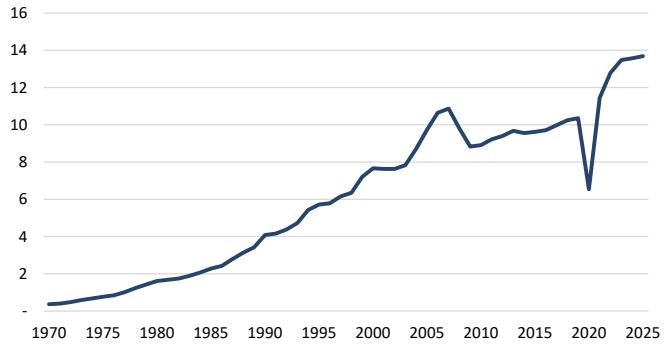
- Greater access to slot machines in regional locations.
- Las Vegas becoming too expensive and pricing out mass-market customers.
- A decline in international visitation.
  - Visitation from Canada and Mexico have both declined since Donald Trump's announcement of tariffs.

Exhibit 26 - Las Vegas Annual Visitors (m's)



Source: Various state gaming bodies, E&P estimates

Exhibit 27 - Las Vegas Annual Gaming Revenue ($bn)



Source: Various state gaming bodies, E&P estimates

Tax Changes

Throughout 2025, there was discussion about what the impacts of the One Big Beautiful Bill would have on the gaming industry. The two most mentioned changes were the 90% cap on gambling loss write-offs (negative impact) and the accelerated depreciation (positive impact).

However, our industry feedback from casinos is that a different tax change will be the most impactful. This is the increase in the IRS reporting threshold from $1,200 to $2,000.

- Under current law, casinos must issue a Form W-2G to slot players who win $1,200 or more.
  - When a player hits a jackpot over $1,200, the slot machine enters a hand-pay / lock-up state
- The $1,200 threshold has remained the same since 1977.
  - Industry groups have been lobbying for a change for several years to raise the threshold to $5,000.
  - However, the limit was only increased to $2,000 but will be indexed to inflation.

Our feedback has been that this will be a headache initially for casinos.

- Each machine must be updated manually, and each cabinet has different settings.

One casino did not believe it would drive incremental replacements unit sales, whilst another said that a few older cabinets would need converting. However, the primary reason we have highlighted this change is the potential upside for GGR.

- One casino mentioned that 60% to 65% of their jackpots above $1.2k fall within the $1.2k to $2.0k range.
- The increased threshold will decrease the number of machines that lock-up and potentially reduce the amount of slot players who cash out winnings within that range.

Social Casino

Although somewhat overlooked in recent years, we believe there may be some positive momentum in these social casino businesses. We discuss the following three drivers below:

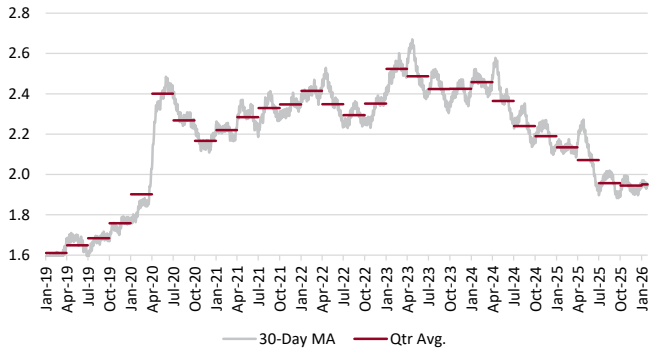
- App revenue data.
- DTC (direct-to-consumer) platforms.
- The recent crackdown on sweepstakes casinos.

App Revenue Data

Since covid, social casino revenue on the Apple & Google platforms has been on the decline. However, the data is gradually becoming less representative given it excludes DTC platforms which are gaining share. Thus, Aristocrat has generally reported modest growth over the past two years despite the downward trend indicated by the chart below.

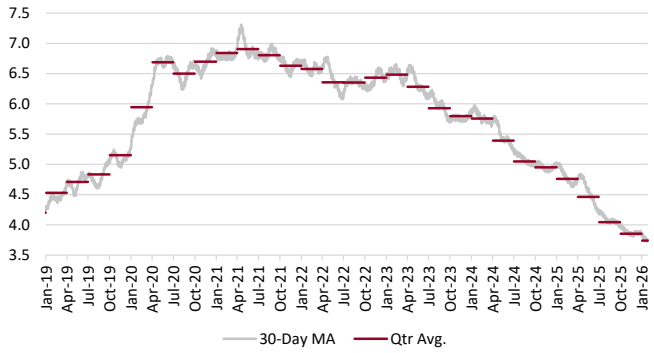
However, the Apple & Google revenue data appears to have stabilised over the past few months. Given that we expect DTC penetration will have continued in the fourth quarter, we believe that Aristocrat & LNW will both will have grown revenue qoq.

Exhibit 28 - Pixel United Social Casino Slots - Average Revenue per Day (US$m)



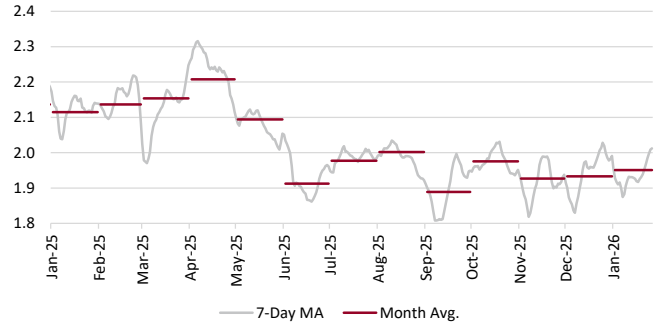
Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels. Apps include: Heart of Vegas, Big Fish Casino, Cashman Casino, Lightning Link, Jackpot Magic Slots & Mighty Fu Casino Slots.

Exhibit 29 - SciPlay Social Casino Slots - Average Revenue per Day (US$m)



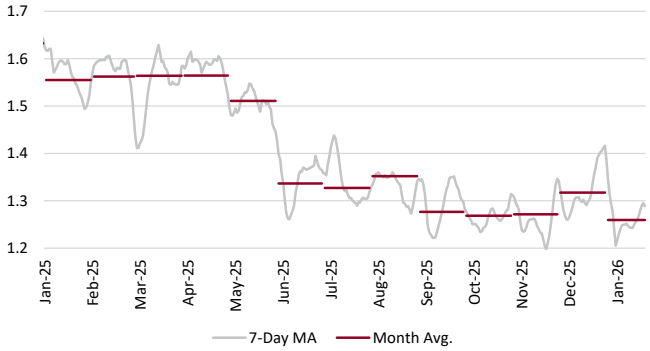
Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels. Apps include: Jackpot Party, Quick Hit Slots, Gold Fish Slots, Monopoly Slots, 88 Fortune Casino, Hot Shot Casino, Bingo Showdown, Blazing 7's Casino.

Exhibit 30 - Pixel United Social Casino Slots - Average Revenue per Day (US$m)



Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels. Apps include: Heart of Vegas, Big Fish Casino, Cashman Casino, Lightning Link, Jackpot Magic Slots & Mighty Fu Casino Slots.

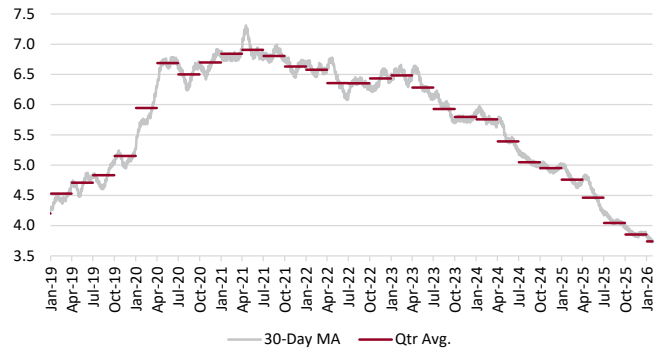
SciPlay Social Casino Slots - Average Revenue per Day (US$m)



Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels. Apps include: Jackpot Party, Quick Hit Slots, Gold Fish Slots, Monopoly Slots, 88 Fortune Casino, Hot Shot Casino, Bingo Showdown, Blazing 7's Casino.

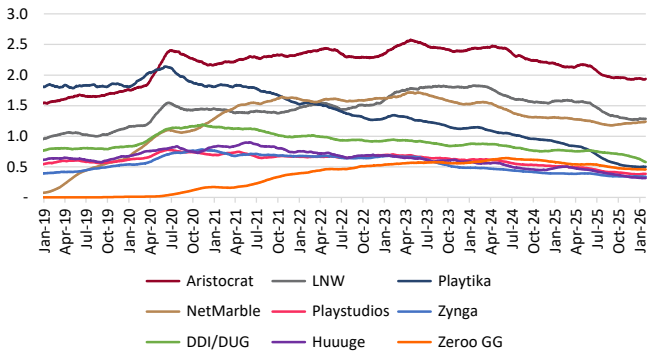
Aristocrat & SciPlay both continue to outperform the market.

Exhibit 31 - Social Casino Slots - Peers Average Revenue per Day (US$m)



Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels. Note: peers include Playtika, NetMarble, Playstudios, Zynga, Double Down Interactive, Huuuge & Zeroo GG.

Exhibit 32 - Social Casino Slots - Peers Average Revenue per Day (US$m) - 90 Day MA



Source: AppMagic, E&P Estimates. Note: excludes non-mobile channels.

DTC Platforms

We believe that recent legal rulings in 2025 have paved the way for an accelerated migration to DTC platforms. This will translate into enhanced social casino margins.

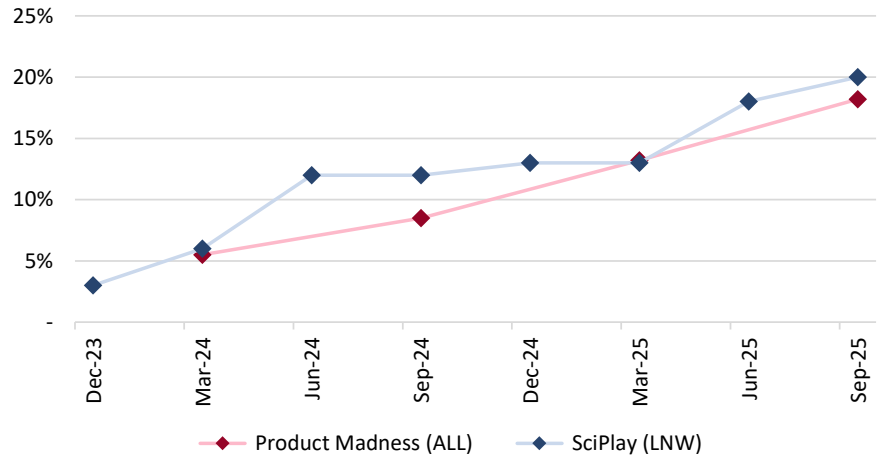
In May-25, Apple updated its US app store guidelines following a ruling from its lawsuit with Epic Games that initially began in Aug-20. The decision reduces anti-steering frictions and states that there should be no prohibition on including buttons, external links, or other

calls to action. Effectively, this reduces Apple's ability to enforce its 30% platform fees on all app store purchases. Developers can now drive players from the app to a web shop rather than players needing to discover the web shop outside the app.

Apple later appealed the verdict, but the US Court of Appeals upheld the majority of the sanctions in Dec-25. However, Apple was able to overturn a sanction that barred them from charging any commission on “linked-out” purchases. The court ruled that Apple may charge a commission only for costs that are “genuinely and reasonably necessary” to coordinate the external hand-off, “and no more” (likely low single digits). These fees have yet to be determined and for now, Apple may not charge any commission until the district court has approved the rate.

Playtika is the current leader in DTC migration. Playtika notes its DTC platforms typically incur ~3%–4% in processing and platform-related costs. Multiple peers have reported that the recent policy changes to app stores have accelerated DTC migration, including Playtika, Playstudios & DoubleU Games. At their Investor Day in May-25, LNW announced a goal of 30% DTC penetration by FY28. They have since stated that they expect to reach their target ahead of time.

Exhibit 33 - Aristocrat & LNW Social Casino DTC Penetration



Source: Company Data, E&P Estimates

Sweepstakes

We also expect social casino to benefit from a domino-effect rollout of sweepstakes-casino bans.

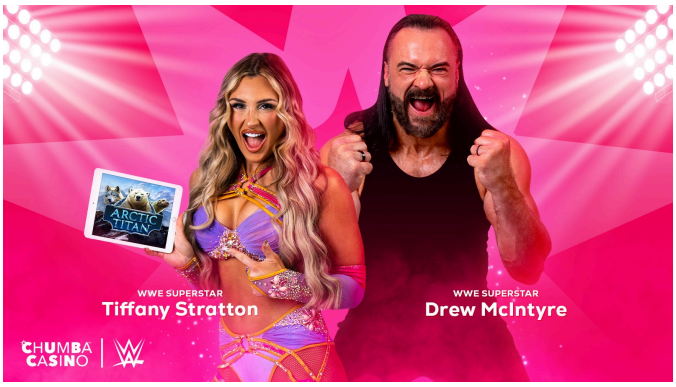
Currently, there are thirteen states that have effectively banned sweepstakes.

- These include five with explicit sweepstakes-casino statutes, six with regulator enforcement bans, and two with long-standing internet-gambling prohibitions.
  - Eight of these bans came in 2025 alone, mostly towards the back-end of the year, including California & New York. There appears to be further momentum heading into 2026, with six additional states considering active bills.
  - Thus far, the majority of bills have passed. The main reason some bills stalled is because they were also bundled with the legalisation of iGaming, such as in Ohio & Arkansas.
- The thirteen states with an active ban currently account for ~33.5% of the US population.
  - The additional six states with active bills would take that figure to ~48.5%.

Given the timing of these bans, we believe that social casino benefit from an uplift over the coming 12-months in particular. The sweepstakes market currently represents ~$4bn of annual NGR. Furthermore, LNW has also reported an uptick specifically in states where sweepstakes have been recently banned.

We still expect sweepstakes to be active in the states where they are not illegal given the short-term cash flow opportunities. Just recently in January, VGW announced a new multi-year partnership with WWE and continues to sponsor Ferrari.

Exhibit 34 - VGW's new partnership with WWE



Source: VGW

Exhibit 35 - VGW's partnership with Ferrari



Source: VGW

However, VGW appears to be preparing for life after sweepstakes. VGW recently launched a new social casino app LuckyLand Casino Lite.

Exhibit 36 - VGW's new LuckyLand Casino



Source: VGW

Exhibit 37 - VGW's new LuckyLand Casino



Source: VGW

iGaming

iGaming is still growing despite a slowdown in state launches.

- However, yoy growth has moderated slightly below +30% over the past four months.

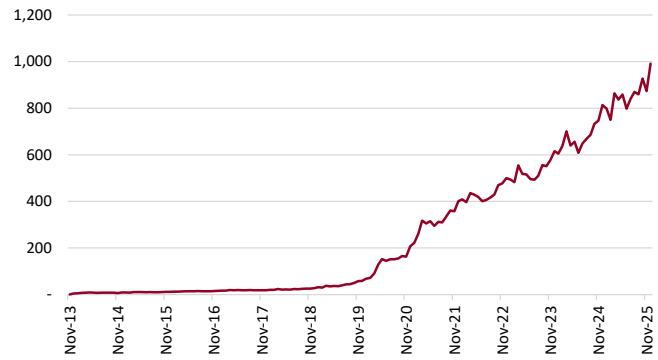
The latest (eighth) state to legalise iGaming in the US is Maine.

- In January, the governor announced new legislation that would grant tribes exclusive rights to offer online gambling.
  - Commercial casino operators Oxford Casino Hotel & Churchill Downs have launched a lawsuit seeking to block the tribal-exclusive framework.
- Maine has ~1.4m residents and accounts for 0.41% of the US population.
  - This lifts the total US population in states where iGaming is legal to 12.27%.

There are numerous states that have been mentioned as possibly of legalising iGaming in 2026. However, these all appear to have a <50% chance of passing.

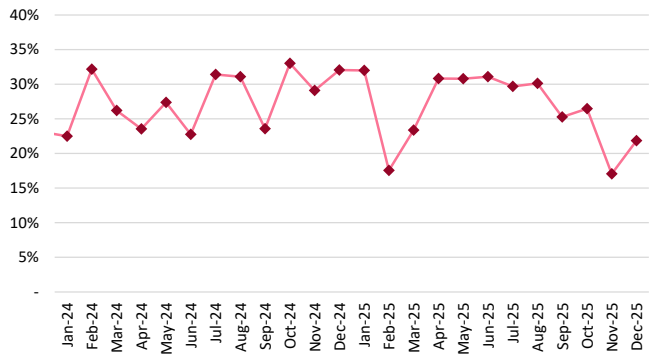
- The crackdown on sweepstakes has improved the odds, as several proposed bills include a framework to simultaneously ban sweepstakes and legalise iGaming.

Exhibit 38 - US Monthly Online Casino GGR (US$m)



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

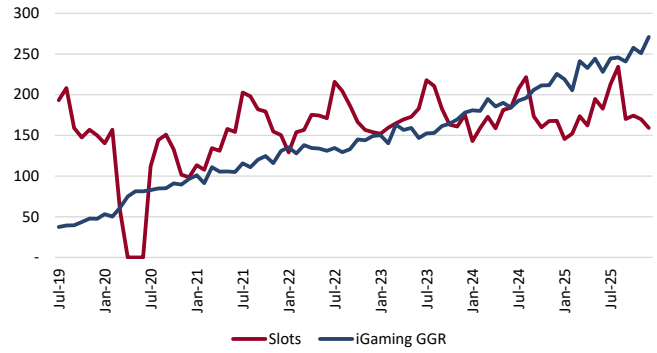
Exhibit 39 - US Online Casino Growth (yoy)



Source: Eilers & Krejcik, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

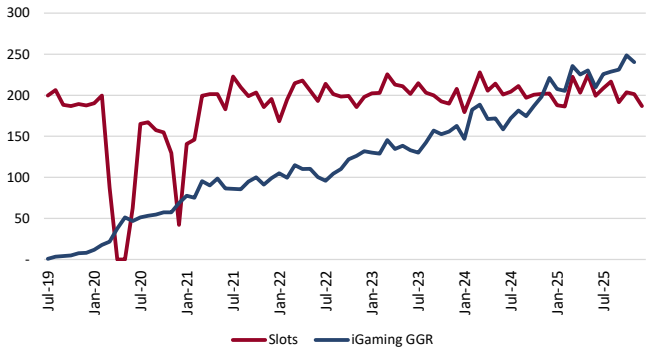
iGaming revenue in both New Jersey and Pennsylvania has surpassed land-based slot revenue.

Exhibit 40 - New Jersey Monthly Slot & iGaming GGR (US $m)



Source: UNLV, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

Exhibit 41 - Pennsylvania Monthly Slot & iGaming GGR (US$m)



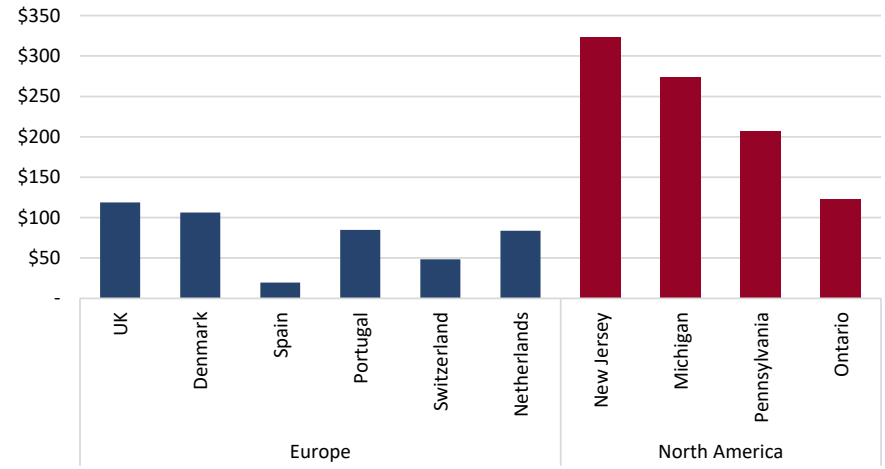
Source: UNLV, various state gaming bodies, E&P Estimates

We think a moderation of US iGaming growth below +30% yoy was inevitable without new state launches. The four biggest markets in North America all have materially higher online casino GGR per adult than other mature market jurisdictions in Europe. However, we acknowledge that there are some differences in tax rates, regulation, and disposable income.

Outside of North America, the two most relevant growth markets are Alberta and Brazil.

- iGaming is legal in Alberta but is run by a government monopoly (PlayAlberta). This is now transitioning to a fully open market with private operators and s expected to resemble Ontario's open-market model.
  - The Alberta government has not set a date, only indicating an expected launch later in 2026.
- Brazil's regulated market went live on 1 January 2025 after transitioning from a grey market.
  - The market produced ~US$6.62bn of online GGR in its first year amongst both sports betting and iGaming.
    - H2 Gambling Capital estimates ~45% of this was iGaming, which translates to ~US$2.98bn of GGR.

Exhibit 42 - Online Casino GGR per Adult (US$) in 2024



Source: UNLV, various gaming bodies, various government data agencies, E&P Estimates.
Note UK data is for the year ending Mar-25.

Changes to Forecasts

We have made the following changes to our overall forecasts.

Aristocrat

- Reduced 1H26 net adds but increased 2H26 net adds due to the timing of key game releases.
- Increased Social Casino revenue & margins
- Adjusted AUD/USD FX assumptions.

Our valuation has declined -5.9% to $65.82 primarily due to negative FX impacts. We retain our Positive recommendation.

Light & Wonder

- Increased 1H26 net adds but decreased 2H26 net adds due to the end of the Monopoly gaming ops licence and the leased unit conversions at Genting's Resorts World NYC casino.
- Increased Social Casino revenue & margins
- Adjusted AUD/USD FX assumptions.

Our valuation has increased +1.2% to $246 and we retain our Positive recommendation.

Exhibit 43 - ALL changes to financial forecasts

		FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	**New**	**6,432.7**	**6,798.6**	**7,304.1**
	Old	6,675.8	7,090.6	7,627.2
	% change	-3.6%	-4.1%	-4.2%
EBITA	**New**	**2,299.7**	**2,425.3**	**2,604.6**
	Old	2,417.3	2,563.9	2,756.5
	% change	-4.9%	-5.4%	-5.5%
NPATA	**New**	**1,635.7**	**1,766.9**	**1,938.8**
	Old	1,722.6	1,872.0	2,056.8
	% change	-5.0%	-5.6%	-5.7%
Valuation	**New**	**$65.82**		
	Old	$69.94		
	Change %	-5.9%		

Source: E&P Estimates

Exhibit 44 - LNW changes to financial forecasts

		FY25E	FY26E	FY27E
Revenue	**New**	**3,342.5**	**3,742.8**	**4,002.0**
	Old	3,343.6	3,702.6	3,971.8
	% Change	-0.0%	+1.1%	+0.8%
AEBITDA	**New**	**1,439.6**	**1,630.8**	**1,798.6**
	Old	1,439.9	1,617.0	1,790.4
	% Change	-0.0%	+0.9%	+0.5%
NPATA	**New**	**567.1**	**689.9**	**806.0**
	Old	567.4	679.8	800.9
	% Change	-0.0%	+1.5%	+0.6%
Valuation	**New**	**$246**		
	Old	$243		
	% Change	+1.2%		

Source: E&P Estimates

Our Forecasts vs Consensus

Our LNW financial forecasts for 4Q25 vs. Visible Alpha consensus are as follows:

- Revenue: E&Pe $918m, VA Consensus $903m (+1.7%)
- AEBITDA: E&Pe $402m, VA Consensus $397m (+1.1%)
- NA Outright Sales Units: E&Pe 6.8k, VA Consensus 6.3k (+6.7%)
- NA Net Adds: E&Pe +950, VA Consensus +881 (+7.8%)

FINANCIAL SUMMARY

Aristocrat Leisure Ltd				ALL-ASX		Positive			Share Price:	AUD53.56
As at:	02/02/2026			Recommendation:						
Year end	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**Year end**	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**
INCOME STATEMENT						FINANCING CASH FLOWS					
Total Operating Income/Revenue		5,673.4	6,297.0	6,432.7	6,798.6	Proceeds from Borrowings		(100.4)	(505.5)	0.0	0.0
EBITDA		2,274.4	2,628.9	2,710.1	2,801.0	Net Proceeds Issue/Buyback of Securities		(837.4)	(853.5)	(490.0)	(600.0)
D&A		(442.5)	(561.4)	(561.9)	(524.5)	Distributions		(447.7)	(538.4)	(556.9)	(595.6)
EBIT		1,831.9	2,067.5	2,148.2	2,276.5	Other Financing Cashflows		(480.6)	(175.5)	0.0	0.0
Net Interest Expense		(60.0)	(101.4)	(68.4)	(44.6)	**Total Financing Cash Flow**		**(1,866.1)**	**(2,072.9)**	**(1,046.9)**	**(1,195.6)**
PBT		1,572.3	1,818.8	2,079.8	2,231.9	Net Change in Cash		(2,207.2)	338.0	528.6	488.0
Tax expense		(414.8)	(634.7)	(561.5)	(580.3)	Free Cashflow		1,271.1	1,475.4	1,545.6	1,683.5
NPAT attributable to s'hers		**1,157.5**	**1,184.1**	**1,518.3**	**1,651.6**	**Year end**	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Adjusted Net Profit		1,157.5	1,184.1	1,518.3	1,651.6	PER SHARE DATA					
Year end	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**	EPS - Adjusted (cents)		183.3	190.6	248.1	273.7
BALANCE SHEET						DPS (cents)		78.0	93.0	90.5	98.0
Assets						Cash Flow Per Share (cents/share)		201.3	237.5	252.5	279.0
Cash		943.8	1,281.8	1,810.4	2,298.3	Book Value ($/sh)		997.8	1,063.0	1,152.5	1,244.7
Current Receivables		1,089.9	1,280.1	1,263.9	1,357.8	**Year end**	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Inventories		277.8	264.1	269.4	287.6	SEGMENTALS					
Other Current Assets		114.7	135.7	135.7	135.7	Gaming Revenue		3,628.6	3,960.0	4,111.8	4,183.6
Total Current Assets		2,426.2	2,961.7	3,479.4	4,079.4	Digital Revenue		1,709.1	1,800.3	1,670.6	1,733.8
Property Plant & Equipment		575.1	581.2	546.8	548.9	Interactive Revenue		335.7	536.7	650.3	881.1
Intangibles		5,346.8	4,943.3	4,834.4	4,781.6	Segment Revenue		5,673.4	6,297.0	6,432.7	6,798.6
Other Non-Current Assets		312.9	284.5	284.5	284.5	Gaming EBITA		2,021.6	2,161.1	2,235.9	2,306.8
Total Non-Current Assets		7,877.2	7,430.8	7,287.4	7,236.8	Digital EBITA		699.8	804.4	827.1	887.5
Total Assets (BS)		10,303.4	10,392.5	10,766.8	11,316.2	Interactive EBITA		104.4	204.6	213.8	274.4
Liabilities						Segment EBITA		2,825.8	3,170.1	3,276.7	3,468.8
Short Term Debt		92.8	99.1	99.1	99.1	**Year end**	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Current Accounts Payable		987.1	1,015.6	920.6	1,002.1	ANALYSIS					
Total Current liabilities		1,578.2	1,798.7	1,701.7	1,795.0	EBITDA Margin (%)		40.1	41.7	42.1	41.2
Long Term Debt		1,990.8	1,606.0	1,606.0	1,606.0	EBIT Margin (%)		32.3	32.8	33.4	33.5
Other Non-Current Liabilities		296.7	299.5	299.5	299.5	Net Profit Margin (%)		20.4	18.8	23.6	24.3
Total Non-Current Liabilities		2,445.3	2,036.6	2,036.6	2,036.6	Capital Employed		7,419.7	6,980.5	6,923.3	6,891.3
Total Liabilities		4,024	3,835	3,738	3,832	Return on Capital Employed (%)		27.5	28.7	30.9	33.0
Total Shareholders' Equity		6,279.9	6,557.2	7,028.5	7,484.6	EBITDA/Capital Employed (%)		34.1	36.5	39.0	40.6
Net Assets		6,279.9	6,557.2	7,028.5	7,484.6	**ROE %**		**17.8**	**18.4**	**22.4**	**22.8**
Book Value		6,279.9	6,557.2	7,028.5	7,484.6	Net Debt/Equity (%)		18.1	6.5	(1.5)	(7.9)
Year end	**Sep**	**2024A**	**2025A**	**2026E**	**2027E**	Net Debt/Net Debt & Equity (%)		15.4	6.1	(1.5)	(8.6)
OPERATING CASH FLOWS						Net Debt/EBITDA (x)		0.5	0.2	(0.0)	(0.2)
EBITDA		2,366.4	2,462.0	2,710.1	2,801.0	Net Interest Cover (x)		11.7	12.6	16.3	18.7
Change in Working Capital		0.0	0.0	(86.2)	(18.7)	GOCF/EBITDA (%)		1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Other Operating Cashflow		5.1	97.3	0.0	0.0	Total Capex/Sales (%)		35.5	(7.0)	6.5	7.0
Gross Operating Cash Flow		**2,371.5**	**2,559.3**	**2,623.9**	**2,782.3**	Working Capital/Sales (%)		0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Net interest paid		(52.7)	(69.7)	(68.4)	(44.6)	D&A/PP&E (%)		76.9	96.6	102.8	95.6
Tax Paid		(553.6)	(555.9)	(561.5)	(580.3)	EV/EBITDA (x)		14.3	15.4	15.0	14.6
Net Operating Cash Flows		**1,765.2**	**1,933.7**	**1,994.0**	**2,157.4**						
Investing Cash Flows											
Purchase of PP&E		(494.1)	(458.3)	(448.4)	(473.9)	BLENDED VALUATION					
Other Investing Cashflows		6.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	Valuation - DCF		65.82	100.0%		
Total Investing CashFlow		**(2,007.2)**	**441.3**	**(418.5)**	**(473.9)**	Valuation - Capitalisation of Earnings		0.00	0.0%		
						Valuation - PER		0.00	0.0%		
						Valuation - SOTP		0.00			
						Valuation		AUD65.82			

Source: Company data, E&P estimates

Light and Wonder				LNW-ASX	
As at:	02/02/2026			Recommendation:	Positive

Year end	Dec	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
INCOME STATEMENT					
Total Operating Income/Revenue		3,188.0	3,342.5	3,742.8	4,002.0
EBITDA		1,245.0	1,439.6	1,630.8	1,798.6
D&A		(360.0)	(406.0)	(434.9)	(438.9)
EBIT		885.0	1,033.6	1,195.9	1,359.7
Net Interest Expense		(294.0)	(318.3)	(357.7)	(330.8)
PBT		591.0	715.3	838.2	1,028.9
Tax expense		(86.0)	(104.1)	(108.9)	(171.4)
Share of profits from associates		0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Minority Interest		0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
NPAT attributable to s'hers		**336.0**	**416.5**	**385.8**	**644.9**
Normalisation Adjustments		169.0	194.7	343.5	212.6
Adjusted Net Profit		505.0	611.2	729.3	857.5
Year end	**Dec**	**2024A**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
BALANCE SHEET					
Assets					
Cash		312.0	147.7	715.3	1,488.9
Current Receivables		585.0	719.7	741.7	804.0
Other Current Assets		134.0	164.0	164.0	164.0
Total Current Assets		1,031.0	1,031.4	1,621.1	2,456.9
Property Plant & Equipment		330.0	401.5	413.0	430.1
Intangibles		615.0	1,021.1	1,008.1	1,012.4
Other Non-Current Assets		397.0	399.0	399.0	399.0
Total Non-Current Assets		4,232.0	5,182.6	5,181.2	5,202.5
Total Assets (BS)		5,263.0	6,214.1	6,802.2	7,659.4
Liabilities					
Short Term Debt		3,870.0	5,142.0	5,142.0	5,142.0
Current Accounts Payable		216.0	179.7	184.5	194.6
Total Current liabilities		4,582.0	5,731.7	5,736.5	5,746.6
Other Non-Current Liabilities		203.0	272.0	272.0	272.0
Total Non-Current Liabilities		203.0	272.0	272.0	272.0
Total Liabilities		4,785	6,004	6,009	6,019
Total Shareholders' Equity		636.0	375.2	883.5	1,661.0
Net Assets		478.0	210.4	793.7	1,640.8
Net Tangible Assets		(2,869.0)	(4,006.9)	(3,485.6)	(2,712.4)
Book Value		636.0	375.2	883.5	1,661.0
Year end	**Dec**	**2024A**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
OPERATING CASH FLOWS					
EBITDA		747.0	1,102.6	1,630.8	1,798.6
Change in Working Capital		(76.0)	(278.9)	(22.1)	(62.6)
Other Operating Cashflow		13.0	(25.0)	(221.0)	(80.0)
Gross Operating Cash Flow		**684.0**	**798.7**	**1,387.7**	**1,656.1**
Net interest paid		(71.0)	(89.3)	(357.7)	(330.8)
Tax Paid		(64.0)	(27.1)	(108.9)	(171.4)
Net Operating Cash Flows		**549.0**	**682.3**	**921.1**	**1,153.8**
Investing Cash Flows					
Purchase of PP&E		(293.0)	(326.6)	(433.5)	(460.2)
Other Investing Cashflows		35.0	(861.0)	0.0	0.0
Total Investing CashFlow		**(258.0)**	**(1,187.6)**	**(433.5)**	**(460.2)**

Year end	Dec	2024A	2025E	2026E	2027E
FINANCING CASH FLOWS					
Proceeds from Borrowings		(11.0)	1,277.0	0.0	0.0
Net Proceeds Issue/Buyback of Securities		(515.0)	(919.0)	0.0	0.0
Other Financing Cashflows		(51.0)	(46.0)	0.0	0.0
Total Financing Cash Flow		**(577.0)**	**312.0**	**0.0**	**0.0**
Net Change in Cash		(286.0)	(193.3)	487.6	693.6
Free Cashflow		256.0	355.7	487.6	693.6
Year end	**Dec**	**2024A**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
PER SHARE DATA					
EPS - Adjusted (cents)		573.9	774.0	909.2	1,052.6
Cash Flow Per Share (cents/share)		290.9	450.4	607.9	851.4
Book Value ($/sh)		722.7	475.1	1,101.4	2,039.0
NTA Per Share ($/sh)		(3,260.2)	(5,073.9)	(4,345.3)	(3,329.7)
Year end	**Dec**	**2024A**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
ANALYSIS					
EBITDA Margin (%)		39.1	43.1	43.6	44.9
EBIT Margin (%)		27.8	30.9	32.0	34.0
Net Profit Margin (%)		15.8	18.3	19.5	21.4
Capital Employed		4,036.0	5,204.7	5,220.3	5,293.9
Return on Capital Employed (%)		22.2	22.4	22.9	25.9
EBITDA/Capital Employed (%)		31.2	31.2	31.3	34.2
ROE %		**72.1**	**120.9**	**115.9**	**67.4**
Net Debt/Equity (%)		559.4	1,331.1	501.0	219.9
Net Debt/Net Debt & Equity (%)		84.8	93.0	83.4	68.7
Net Debt/EBITDA (x)		2.9	3.5	2.7	2.0
Net Interest Cover (x)		3.0	3.2	3.3	4.1
GOCF/EBITDA (%)		0.9	0.7	0.9	0.9
Total Capex/Sales (%)		9.2	9.8	11.6	11.5
Working Capital/Sales (%)		0.1	0.2	0.1	0.2
D&A/PP&E (%)		109.1	101.1	105.3	102.0
EV/EBITDA (x)		15.8	13.5	11.7	10.3

BLENDED VALUATION		
Valuation - DCF	246.00	0.0%
Valuation - Capitalisation of Earnings	0.00	0.0%
Valuation - PER	246.00	1.0%
Valuation - SOTP	0.00	
Valuation	AUD246.00	

Share Price: AUD167.06

Source: Company data, E&P estimates

RESEARCH RECOMMENDATION DEFINITIONS

Positive	Stock is expected to outperform the S&P/ASX 200 over the coming 24 months.
Neutral	Stock expected to perform in line with the S&P/ASX 200 over the coming 24 months.
Negative	Stock is expected to underperform the S&P/ASX 200 over the coming 24 months.
Speculative Buy	Stock has limited history from which to derive a fundamental investment view or its prospects are highly dependent on event risk, e.g. Successful exploration, scientific breakthrough, high commodity prices, regulatory change, etc. Consequently, the stock is considered a high-risk investment which may be prone to high volatility in share price movements, have a greater risk of capital loss and/or the stock may have low liquidity.
Suspended	Stock is temporarily suspended due to compliance with applicable regulatory and/or E&P policies in circumstances where E&P is acting in an advisory capacity.
Not Rated	Stock is not included in our investment research universe.

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Recommendations are primarily determined with reference to how a stock ranks relative to the S&P/ASX 200 on the following criteria:

Valuation	Composite of Rolling 12-month prospective multiples and discounted cash flow (DCF), or DCF for resource stocks.
Earnings Outlook	Forecast 2-year EPS growth.
Earnings Momentum	Percentage change in the current consensus EPS estimate for the stock (rolling 1-year forward basis) over the consensus EPS estimate for the stock 3 months ago.
Shareholder Returns	Composite of forecast ROE (rolling 1-year forward basis) and the percentage change in ROE over 2 years.
Debt Servicing Capacity	Rolling 12-month EBIT Interest Cover ratio.
Cyclical Risk	Qualitative assessment of the 2-year outlook for a stock/industry's profit cycle.
Industry Quality	Qualitative assessment of an industry's growth/returns potential and company specific management capability.
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